Continuation Primacy

Agency, Coordination, and the Explanatory Priority of Admissible Futures

On this account, continuation structure can scaffold, constrain, and partly explain agency without automatically generating an agent.

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Abstract

Many theories begin with entities and then explain action, coordination, identity, and persistence through their interactions. The Continuation Primacy Thesis proposes a deliberate inversion: first model the possible and admissible continuations from a state, then ask which participant boundaries, identities, coordinated trajectories, and forms of agency remain intelligible within that structure.

The inversion is powerful but does not by itself prove that the future is metaphysically prior to entities. This paper distinguishes formal, explanatory, constitutive, and ontological priority. It specifies the first two, treats the third as a domain-dependent hypothesis, and leaves the fourth open. It replaces several type-invalid equations with a profile over states, conceivable and admissible transitions, viability predicates, participant trajectories, identity criteria, and joint continuation.

On this account, continuation structure can scaffold, constrain, and partly explain agency without automatically generating an agent. Shared possible futures do not alone constitute coordination, trajectory overlap does not alone establish identity, and persistence does not establish legitimacy. Continuation Primacy is presented as a focused research thesis and entry point into Dynatology, not as a duplicate of its broader formal architecture.

Source, Evidence, and Standing

This is an AI-assisted integrated edition derived from one exact author manuscript. Its custody and comparison manifest is
`work/paper-saturation-v1/evidence/`

`continuation-primacy/integration-custody-manifest.v0.1.json`,
SHA-256

DFDD78A4C4CA7D165C3915ED4796079BB38FC79FCF214327D91ED84130B0FD02.
The source remains unchanged.

The thesis, named constructs, examples, and inversion are author material. The revised formalisms, priority hierarchy, corpus distinctions, counterevidence program, and decisions are AI editorial or synthetic candidates until adopted. No external research was conducted; the source bibliography has not been independently verified.

1. The Explanatory Inversion

An entity-first account begins with agents and derives a system from their actions. A continuation-first account begins with a structured set of transitions and asks which persistent participants, coordinated paths, and action capacities can exist within it.

The second perspective can reveal constraints that disappear when the agent is treated as primitive. An institution, protocol, ecological niche, or market may outlast particular participants. A policy or physical boundary may shape behavior before a particular actor chooses. Yet this observation underdetermines ontology: durable structure can be caused, reproduced, interpreted, or contested by entities even while constraining them.

Continuation Primacy should therefore begin as an explanatory reordering rather than a declaration that entities are unreal or the future exists independently.

2. Four Meanings of Priority

The word **primary** can express different claims:

1. **Formal priority:** a model defines states and transition conditions before defining participant trajectories over them.
2. **Explanatory priority:** some phenomena are explained more compactly by continuation constraints than by isolated actor properties.
3. **Constitutive priority:** a participant's identity depends on continuity under a declared identity criterion.
4. **Ontological priority:** continuation is more fundamental in reality than participants.

The first is a modeling choice. The second is empirically comparable. The third may hold in selected domains. The fourth is a metaphysical hypothesis that neither notation nor examples establish.

The paper's defensible central claim is therefore:

> In some domains, admissible-continuation structure may provide a more powerful explanatory basis for participation, coordination, and persistence than an entity-first model.

3. Typed Continuation System

Define a profiled system at time t:

$$\mathcal{D}_t = (X_t, \Omega_t, A_t, C_t, V_t, O_t),$$

where X_t is the modeled state space, $\Omega_t \subseteq X_t \times X_{t+1}$ the conceivable transition relation, $A_t \subseteq \Omega_t$ the transitions admitted under constitution or constraint profile C_t, V_t a viability predicate, and O_t the observation and evidence regime.

"Admissible" is never ambient. It is admissible under a named profile, authority, time, and interpretation. Physical possibility, logical consistency, legal permission, institutional authorization, technical availability, and ethical acceptability are different predicates and may conflict.

The one-step forward continuation field is:

$$F^+_{A,t}(x) = \{x' \in X_{t+1} \mid (x, x') \in A_t\}.$$

The field is a model-relative successor set. It is not an independent substance, an intention, or proof that every represented transition will occur.

4. Participation

A participant cannot be intersected directly with a transition relation. Let participant i have a boundary rule B_i, a local-state projection π_i, and a trajectory:

$$\gamma_i = (x_0, x_1, \ldots, x_n).$$

Participant i is constitutionally participating under profile C when the projected transitions relevant to B_i satisfy the declared participation predicate. In the simplest case:

$$(x_k, x_{k+1}) \in A_k \quad \text{for all assessed } k.$$

This defines admitted participation, not physical existence. If $A_t = \varnothing$, the profile admits no immediate successor; existing objects need not disappear. A deadlock may instead reveal an incomplete model, terminal state, conflicting constraints, or genuine continuation collapse.

5. Derived Agency

Stable participation is insufficient for agency: a rock, log record, or passive component can persist through admitted transitions. An operational agency profile should test at least boundary maintenance, sensing or state discrimination,

option selection, intervention, feedback sensitivity, and pursuit or preservation of a declared objective or viability condition.

Continuation structure may enable or constrain these capacities. Agency can then be **continuation-scaffolded** or **continuation-constituted under a profile** without claiming that every stable trajectory is an agent.

A comparative test should ask whether the continuation-first model predicts interventions, adaptation, failure, and persistence better than an entity-first alternative after accounting for model complexity.

6. Identity and Persistence

Trajectory overlap at adjacent times is too weak to establish identity: unrelated processes can share states, while one persisting process can undergo radical change. Identity requires an explicit equivalence or continuity criterion:

$$\gamma_a \sim_{I,p} \gamma_b,$$

where p identifies the domain profile and its evidentiary tests. Possible criteria include causal continuity, organizational invariants, legal succession, cryptographic lineage, memory, bodily continuity, functional organization, or accountable reconstruction.

Continuation can support identity judgments, but it does not choose the correct criterion. Identity claims should record boundary, invariants, tolerated change, breaks, observer, evidence, and competing criteria.

Persistence may be measured by more than set overlap: reachable-set similarity, invariant retention, path viability, lineage continuity, or robustness under perturbation. No single scalar should be treated as universal.

7. Coordination

Two participants having overlapping successor sets does not prove coordination. They may independently reach the same state, compete for it, or make each other's paths impossible.

Coordination requires a joint model. Let J_t describe joint candidate transitions and $A_t^J \subseteq J_t$ those jointly admissible under declared compatibility, resource, authority, and timing constraints. Participants coordinate when their coupled actions produce or preserve a joint trajectory satisfying a coordination predicate that neither local trajectory alone establishes.

This connects Continuation Primacy to **The Optional Coordinator**: coordination can arise from compatible continuation, while hierarchy may become useful when individually admissible paths are jointly inconsistent. It does not follow that hierarchy is always necessary or that shared futures are sufficient.

8. Intelligence, Meaning, and Consciousness

Constitutional Intelligence asks whether a continuation structure preserves viable paths under perturbation. That is a system-level performance property, not evidence that a field literally possesses a mind. Participants may benefit from an intelligent design or adaptive ecology without inheriting agency or intelligence automatically.

Constitutional Meaning treats a distinction as meaning-bearing when it alters admissible continuation under a profile. Causal influence, modeled relevance, authorized binding, and human semantic content should remain separable.

The **Ableman Consciousness Ontology** adds integrated binding, situational stakes, recursion, and self-authored revision. Continuation participation alone does not establish consciousness, moral standing, or subjective experience.

These papers specialize different questions. Continuation Primacy supplies an explanatory inversion; it does not settle their stronger criteria.

9. Continuation and Legitimacy

Persistence is not legitimacy. A process may continue through coercion, capture, inertia, exploit, or outdated authority. **Corruption as Illegitimate Continuation** supplies this essential distinction: continuation must remain attributable to declared warrant, invariants, evidence, renewal, and contest.

Accordingly:

$$\textit{continued} \neq \textit{admissible} \neq \textit{legitimate} \neq \textit{desirable}.$$

The relation A_t represents admission under a profile. Whether that profile is lawful, just, current, or properly constituted is a separate question.

10. Time and Future Geometry

A continuation field represents structured successor possibilities from a present model. Calling this "constitutional time" is useful only if it yields measurable distinctions from ordinary transition-system analysis. It should not imply that represented futures already exist or govern causally from the future.

The productive claim is geometric: admissibility can induce reachability, neighborhoods, boundaries, components, bottlenecks, and path costs over modeled possibility. This is developed generally in **Dynatology**.

11. Corpus Role and Authorial Compression

Continuation Primacy should remain a compact philosophical and explanatory entry point: why start from admissible futures rather than isolated entities?

Dynatology is the general formal system containing possibility spaces, continuation fields, viability, participation, identity, meaning, intelligence, coordination, topology, composition, and inference.

Constitutional Intelligence, **Constitutional Meaning**, and **The Optional Coordinator** develop specialized projections. **Corruption as Illegitimate Continuation** distinguishes persistence from legitimate continuation. **ACO** places stricter criteria on consciousness-relevant participation.

This routing prevents the paper from re-declaring the whole Dynatology architecture while preserving its strongest conceptual contribution.

The **Governed Meaning Base (GMB)** can retain source definitions, profile-specific formalisms, evidence, disagreements, and revisions. The universal **GSM** can relate the thesis to its specialized projections without promoting similarity to identity or ontology to fact.

12. Realization Funnel

$$\begin{aligned} & Possibility \\ & \rightarrow Specification \\ & \rightarrow CM_1 \\ & \rightarrow CM_2 \\ & \rightarrow IC \\ & \rightarrow IR \\ & \rightarrow Evidence \\ & \rightarrow Revision \end{aligned} .$$

- **Possibility:** compare entity-first, continuation-first, relational, process, hybrid, and domain-specific accounts.
- **Specification:** define states, candidate transitions, admissibility profiles, viability, participants, identity, coordination, evidence, and claim ceilings.
- **CM1:** retain formally coherent profiles, including conflicting or ethically unacceptable ones.
- **CM2:** prefer profiles by explanatory gain, empirical adequacy, calibration, inspectability, ethical acceptability, and cost.
- **IC:** select an Instance Constitution or Instance Configuration for one domain and comparison.
- **IR:** produce an Instance Realization or Implementation Realization of instrumentation, models, baselines, and tests.
- **Evidence:** compare predictions, interventions, persistence, coordination, and failure against alternatives.
- **Revision:** change the thesis, profile, or realization in response to counterevidence.

This paper reaches Specification and proposes CM1/CM2 criteria. It does not select an IC or certify an IR. Realization-stage IR remains distinct from

Intermediate Representation in MCIR or other compiler contexts.

13. Research and Evaluation Program

Choose bounded domains with observable states, participants, interventions, and outcomes. Specify competing entity-first, continuation-first, and hybrid models before evaluation. Require each to predict transitions, perturbation responses, participant persistence, coordination failures, and boundary cases.

Compare predictive accuracy, intervention success, explanatory compression, out-of-sample transfer, calibration, sensitivity to profile choice, identity disagreement, joint-admissibility errors, measurement cost, and ethical consequence. Use ablations to determine whether continuation structure adds information beyond participant features.

Metaphysical priority is not directly validated by predictive success. The strongest empirical result would support explanatory priority under stated conditions.

Continuation as a Bounded Projection

Across the completed P1 corpus, Continuation Primacy is best understood as an explanatory projection rather than a second universal stack. Its nearest interfaces divide cleanly:

- **Work:** *Dynatology*
  Contribution: General inquiry into possibility, constraint, transition, realization, and evidence.
  Boundary: Continuation Primacy selects future reachability and viability as a lens within that larger domain.
- **Work:** *Terminability*
  Contribution: Conditions under which stopping, refusal, completion, or non-continuation is legitimate.
  Boundary: A theory of continuation is incomplete if it treats stopping as failure rather than an admissible terminal result.
- **Work:** *The Optional Coordinator*
  Contribution: Coordination without making one coordinator the source of participant identity or authority.
  Boundary: Coordination changes joint reachability; it need not create an ontologically prior collective.
- **Work:** *Constitutional Collective with Optional Overmind*
  Contribution: Institutional profiles for collective cognition and optional higher-order coordination.
  Boundary: A CCOO is one possible realization of governed joint continuation, not evidence for the metaphysical thesis.

Let R_t be reachable continuations, $A_t \subseteq R_t$ admissible continuations, and $V_t \subseteq A_t$ continuations that remain viable under the declared horizon and resource model. Terminability adds a set T_t of legitimate terminal transitions. The operative choice surface is therefore:

$$C_t = V_t \cup T_t.$$

This corrects a latent bias in continuation language. A lawful refusal, completed task, safe shutdown, retirement, or deliberate non-reproduction can be a successful constitutional outcome. A system that maximizes continuation cardinality without representing terminal legitimacy can preserve harmful, coercive, or resource-exhausting trajectories.

The cross-paper invariant is: **reachability does not imply admissibility; admissibility does not imply preference; preference does not forbid legitimate termination; persistence does not imply legitimacy.** Evidence must state the horizon, state abstraction, resource assumptions, affected parties, and authority under which a trajectory is classified.

Within the universal GSM, Continuation Primacy contributes relations such as `CAN_CONTINUE_AS`, `REQUIRES_RESOURCE`, `EXCLUDES_FUTURE`, `COORDINATES_WITH`, `TERMINATES_BY`, `REMAINS_VIABLE_UNDER`, and `CONTESTED_BY`. These relations describe a model, not the world's complete future geometry.

This integration establishes four editorial commitments: whether to present Continuation Primacy explicitly as a Dynatology projection; whether legitimate terminal transitions belong in its core formalism; whether the Optional Coordinator and CCOO remain examples rather than components; and whether the paper's headline should emphasize a methodological inversion instead of ontological priority.

Evidence-Informed Continuation Without Architectural Capture

The fixed-seed comparison with ACG for Quants, Jnana, governed retrieval, and the Cognitive Kernel tests Continuation Primacy as a lens rather than an umbrella:

$$\begin{aligned} C^* = (&subject, horizon, reachable, admissible, preferred,\\ &viable, terminal, evidence, exigence, authority,\\ &resources, affected_parties, uncertainty) \end{aligned} \quad .$$

Governed retrieval can supply purpose-specific evidence and counterevidence for a continuation classification. CogK can recognize an exigence, allocate

attention, assign or transfer custody, evaluate sufficiency, and request a decision. Neither retrieved relevance nor felt pressure determines admissibility, preference, authority, or legitimacy.

Jnana can mediate a selected continuation or terminal transition through law, lowering, effect, receipt, and projection contracts. It is a possible realization architecture, not evidence for the explanatory or metaphysical thesis.

ACG for Quants has no direct evidentiary relation to Continuation Primacy. A factor's continuation, decay, or retirement uses domain-specific financial and governance criteria and cannot validate a general continuation theory.

The universal GSM can type
`CLASSIFIES_CONTINUATION_WITH_EVIDENCE`,
`TRIGGERED_BY_EXIGENCE_CLAIM`, `REQUIRES_SEPARATE_AUTHORITY`, `MEDIATED_BY_JNANA_PROFILE`, `TERMINATES_LEGITIMATELY`, `RETAINS_CONTINUATION_UNCERTAINTY`,
and
`HAS_NO_MATERIAL_RELATION_TO_QUANT_FACTOR_DECAY`.

This randomized review establishes four editorial commitments: adopt the evidence-informed continuation object; keep exigence and retrieval below decision authority; treat Jnana as an optional realization; and record the nonrelation to quant factor continuation.

A Non-Authoritative Continuation Decision Docket

Nine retained downstream uses employ Continuation Primacy as a classification lens. ATC uses continuation as a candidate prerequisite rather than a consciousness criterion. Cold boot turns selected continuation obligations into a resumption protocol. CCOO and the Optional Coordinator compare joint reachability. Dynatology supplies the wider possibility grammar. CogK and governed retrieval assemble needs and evidence. Jnana may mediate a selected transition. Terminability gives legitimate closure equal standing. ACG for Quants remains an explicit nonrelation because factor persistence cannot validate the general thesis.

The lens becomes operational through a decision docket:

$$\begin{aligned} D = (&subject, current_state, horizon, options, reachability,\\ &admissibility, viability, preference, terminality,\\ &reversibility, resources, affected_parties, evidence, \\ &uncertainty, authority, custody, decision, effect,\\ &review) \end{aligned}$$

Classification and choice are separate. A model, retriever, coordinator, or Cognitive Kernel may populate or challenge the option classes without receiving authority to continue or terminate the subject. The docket should preserve

options excluded by abstraction, unknown transitions, resource conflicts, irreversibility, dissent, and the consequences of delay. A larger reachable set is not automatically safer or better.

Evidence changes should reopen only the dependent classifications whose premises changed. Cold-boot reconstruction can restore the docket without restoring current grants or external conditions. Joint continuation may improve while one participant bears unacceptable loss. Legitimate terminality may be preferred even when technical continuation remains possible.

The universal GSM can type
`CLASSIFIES_CONTINUATION_OPTION`,
`POPULATES_DOCKET_WITHOUT_DECIDING`, `BINDS_AFFECTED_PARTY`, `ESTIMATES_REVERSIBILITY`,
`REOPENS_CONTINUATION_CLASSIFICATION`, `RESTORES_DOCKET_WITHOUT_AUTHORITY`,
`PREFERS_LEGITIMATE_TERMINALITY`, and
`RECORDS_NO_QUANT_EVIDENTIARY_RELATION`.

This reverse-dependency review establishes four editorial commitments: adopt the continuation decision docket; separate classification from transition authority; require affected-party, resource, irreversibility, and delay analysis; and make evidence-triggered reopening and legitimate terminal outcomes first-class.

14. Counterevidence and Failure Modes

The thesis should be narrowed or rejected where: (1) priority is left undefined; (2) formal priority is presented as ontology; (3) a modeled future is treated as causally real; (4) admissibility lacks a profile; (5) physical, legal, ethical, and technical possibility are conflated; (6) A_t is inferred only from observed behavior; (7) forbidden or unobserved transitions are confused; (8) terminal states are called participant nonexistence; (9) passive persistence is called agency; (10) sensing and intervention are absent; (11) stable trajectories arise from external control; (12) identity relies only on overlap; (13) identity criteria conflict; (14) substrate replacement breaks causal lineage; (15) shared futures are called coordination; (16) resource conflict is omitted; (17) coordination requires unmodeled communication; (18) viability is undefined; (19) continuation intelligence is anthropomorphized; (20) causal influence is called meaning without qualification; (21) continuation participation is called consciousness; (22) persistence is called legitimacy; (23) corrupt continuation passes the profile; (24) institutional persistence is imposed by participants rather than prior to them; (25) examples are anecdotal; (26) cross-domain substrate neutrality is assumed; (27) cardinality metrics fail on infinite or incomparable fields; (28) observational equivalence prevents model discrimination; (29) entity-first baselines outperform; (30) Dynatology already subsumes the contribution; (31) corpus interfaces are merged; (32) a specification is presented as implemented; (33) GMB inclusion becomes validation; (34) GSM adjacency becomes derivation; (35) the source bibliography is inaccurate; or (36) external research contradicts novelty or priority claims.

Modeling Futures First Does Not Make the Future Metaphysically Primary

Public orientation

Continuation Primacy reverses the usual explanatory order: model possible and admissible transitions first, then ask which participant boundaries, identities, coordinated paths, and agency capacities remain intelligible. This is a formal and potentially explanatory perspective. Constitutive priority is domain-dependent; ontological priority remains open.

Adversarial tests

1. **Ontology-from-notation attack.** Defining transitions before agents in a model is treated as proof that continuations are more fundamental in reality.
2. **Model-completeness attack.** Represented futures are treated as all futures despite unknown states, innovation, adversarial action, observer limits, and open environments.
3. **Admissibility-legitimacy attack.** A permitted or persistent transition is treated as desirable, lawful, fair, or authorized.
4. **Agency-erasure attack.** Institutions, protocols, and environments explain behavior so completely that participant choice, resistance, interpretation, and causal contribution disappear.
5. **Identity-overlap attack.** Trajectory continuity, state similarity, or shared reachable futures is treated as personal or artifact identity.
6. **Coordination-overlap attack.** Compatible or overlapping continuations are treated as joint intention, cooperation, consent, or shared purpose.
7. **Survivorship-legitimacy attack.** What persists or remains viable is treated as what deserves to continue.
8. **Dynatology-duplication attack.** The focused thesis expands until it duplicates the wider Dynatology architecture and loses a distinct falsifiable role.

Claim and evidence ceiling

The paper establishes a typed modeling inversion and research thesis. It does not establish metaphysical priority, complete continuation spaces, derived consciousness, automatic agency, identity, coordination, intelligence, meaning, legitimacy, or empirical superiority to entity-first accounts. Its proper corpus role is a bounded projection and entry point into Dynatology.

Evaluation requires paired entity-first and continuation-first models, predictive and explanatory comparisons, negative domains, observer and uncertainty bounds, explicit identity and coordination criteria, affected-party interpretation, and current external research. None was performed in this pass.

Reader-facing consequence

The thesis is strongest when it reveals which futures a system makes available or impossible before naming an agent - while keeping open who created those conditions, who contests them, and whether any admissible continuation should be chosen.

16. Conclusion

Continuation Primacy is most valuable as an inversion of explanatory order. Instead of assuming agents and asking what they do, it asks which continuations are possible, which are admitted, which remain viable, and what participant boundaries and identities those structures can sustain.

That inversion does not erase entities or prove a metaphysics of the future. It offers a research program: define the continuation profile, compare it with entity-first alternatives, preserve the difference between persistence and legitimacy, and test whether the structure of admissible futures explains more with less distortion.

Reference and Verification Note

No external source was searched in this pass, and the bibliography inherited from the source was not independently checked. Further evidentiary strengthening requires authorized primary-source review of process philosophy, metaphysics of persistence, agency, identity, emergence, dynamical and transition systems, viability theory, biology, cognition, economics, institutional theory, distributed systems, coordination, consciousness, and competing entity-first accounts.

Corpus-Wide Reference Positioning

This paper argues that many theories begin with entities and then explain action, coordination, identity, and persistence through their interactions. Its nearest external comparison fields are provenance, governance, open sovereign. The sources in [E1], [E2], [E3], [E4], [E5], [E6], [E7] are cited as predecessor literature, adjacent standards, or counterpressure - not as evidence that they caused the Ableman framework or that they validate its novel claims. The comparison isolates where established work already supplies provenance, formal assurance, institutional constraint, empirical method, or engineering practice, and where this paper adds a distinct claim about admissibility, authority, semantic custody, or governed realization.

Within the Ableman corpus, the highest-priority current cross-links are [A1], [A2], [A3], [A4], [A5], [A6], [A7]. These are links among separately custodied works, not silent identity mergers. Their role is to expose mutual dependencies, terminology collisions, and places where a reader should traverse the corpus before treating this paper as self-sufficient.

Reference-pass counterevidence and limit search

The pass applied the following pressure tests: A complete provenance graph can faithfully record a false or unauthorized process; provenance is evidence about lineage, not automatic truth or legitimacy. A written constitution can legitimate domination as easily as constrain it unless amendment, participation, enforcement, and appeal remain effective in practice. Source availability and reproducible builds improve inspectability but do not alone guarantee comprehensibility, practical exit, hardware control, or sustainable maintenance. These limits are not generic disclaimers: they identify the assumptions that a later empirical, formal, or implementation review must try to break.

Reference-pass influence and novelty boundary

No newly added external source is asserted to be a documented authorial influence unless the predecessor source already said so. `Predecessor` means earlier relevant work;

`adjacent` means a useful comparison; `standard` means an interoperability or assurance baseline; and `counterevidence` marks work that narrows or pressures a claim. Novelty therefore remains a reviewable, claim-level question rather than an inference from a low similarity score or an absent citation.

References

External scholarship, standards, and prior art

[**E1**] W3C. *PROV-O: The PROV Ontology.* W3C Recommendation, 30 April 2013. https://www.w3.org/TR/prov-o/ **Relationship:** Adjacent provenance standard; it models entities, activities, and agents, but does not by itself establish the paper's stronger authority or standing claims.

[**E2**] Santiago Torres-Arias et al. "in-toto: Providing Farm-to-Table Guarantees for Bits and Bytes." *28th USENIX Security Symposium*, 2019, pp. 1393-1410. usenix.org source **Relationship:** Predecessor supply-chain lineage system used for comparison; no influence claim is made unless the source head already documents one.

[**E3**] OpenSSF. *Supply-chain Levels for Software Artifacts (SLSA), Version 1.2.* 2026. https://slsa.dev/spec/v1.2/ **Relationship:** Adjacent software-supply-chain assurance standard, especially relevant to provenance and verification boundaries.

[**E4**] OpenTelemetry Authors. *OpenTelemetry Specification.* https://opentelemetry.io/docs/specs/otel/ **Relationship:** Adjacent observability standard for traces, metrics, logs, and context propagation; telemetry is not equated with adjudicated evidence.

[**E5**] Elinor Ostrom. *Governing the Commons: The Evolution of Institutions for Collective Action.* Cambridge University Press, 1990. DOI:

10.1017/CBO9780511807763. https://doi.org/10.1017/CBO9780511807763
Relationship: Predecessor institutional account of rule-governed collective action and polycentric governance.

[**E6**] Wil Waluchow and Dimitrios Kyritsis. "Constitutionalism." *Stanford Encyclopedia of Philosophy*, substantive revision 2023. https://plato.stanford.edu/entries/constitutionalism/
Relationship: Adjacent legal-philosophical account of limited authority; included to expose differences between political and computational constitutionalism.

[**E7**] Lawrence Lessig. *Code: Version 2.0*. Basic Books, 2006. https://codev2.cc/
Relationship: Predecessor argument that software architecture regulates behavior; the paper's contribution may be to make such regulation inspectable and revisable.

Ableman corpus

[**A1**] Adam Ableman. *Reasoning by Way of Receipts*. Ableman Corpus current edition; work identity
`AMCS-LOCAL-WORK-04E427F6F4D94454`;
source SHA-256
`AF86A66CCD6A103DD75208500AE99148911A6453B6DFDF36A954279F21AB8489`.
Corpus relationship: priority cross-link selected by corpus profile and similarity review; no identity merger or publication effect.

[**A2**] Adam Ableman. *The Epistemic Lineage Engine*. Ableman Corpus current edition; work identity
`AMCS-LOCAL-WORK-E0EC3DC7EABF5060`;
source SHA-256
`CDD74D9AFAB6532645E68F7F6C9F0F7A9E472D9B8E717290522566FF8DC01F11`.
Corpus relationship: priority cross-link selected by corpus profile and similarity review; no identity merger or publication effect.

[**A3**] Adam Ableman. *The Three Hash Rule*. Ableman Corpus current edition; work identity `PAPER.PUB.20788617`;
source SHA-256
`F6FA73D083B70711A8C817F7779751D1506FEBA0E356DB9805BB1570663731B5`.
Corpus relationship: priority cross-link selected by corpus profile and similarity review; no identity merger or publication effect.

[**A4**] Adam Ableman. *A Formal Theory of Work Custody*. Ableman Corpus current edition; work identity
`AMCS-LOCAL-WORK-C8F2F9BF38C45E29`;
source SHA-256
`A80657E21BA277ADF1C229A2AAE221963B97A62EA2AF3EBC36434A916A8EEA44`.
Corpus relationship: priority cross-link selected by corpus profile and similarity review; no identity merger or publication effect.

[**A5**] Adam Ableman. *Governance Witnesses*. Ableman Corpus current edition;

work identity
AMCS-LOCAL-WORK-9E8DA0EFE860DE5D;
source SHA-256
8BF8C3646040F6E1F5222A8AA92C1106AA1F841E8A2C65402F468C83D59D06E5.
Corpus relationship: priority cross-link selected by corpus profile and similarity review; no identity merger or publication effect.

[**A6**] Adam Ableman. *Ableman Constitutional Governance*. Ableman Corpus current edition; work identity
AMCS-LOCAL-WORK-79353AF163A4B0F1;
source SHA-256
FB0D9B2D3D54168FFE70B24308D1B2766D6D663ED24502D475E975939BE97C8B.
Corpus relationship: priority cross-link selected by corpus profile and similarity review; no identity merger or publication effect.

[**A7**] Adam Ableman. *Constitutional Theory*. Ableman Corpus current edition; work identity
AMCS-LOCAL-WORK-D2D97C4042FD281F;
source SHA-256
FACC256EDDE5A7D7EA18133CFC9C060CFB8C3811B0221E1969E62347F2BB69CF.
Corpus relationship: priority cross-link selected by corpus profile and similarity review; no identity merger or publication effect.

Editorial source notes retained from predecessor

The entries below are corpus-internal comparison and dependency sources. Their inclusion does not establish external validation of this paper's empirical, safety, novelty, or performance claims.

Adam Ableman *A Theory of Agentic Observation.* Zenodo, 2026. doi:10.5281/zenodo.20437813

Adam Ableman *CARA: Constrained Artificial Reasoning Architecture.* Zenodo, 2025. doi:10.5281/zenodo.18099715

Adam Ableman *Constitutional Computation.* Zenodo, 2026. doi:10.5281/zenodo.20624488

Adam Ableman *Constraint-Bearing Composability.* Zenodo, 2026. doi:10.5281/zenodo.21632061

Adam Ableman *Fractal Governance Architecture.* Zenodo, 2026. doi:10.5281/zenodo.20754189

Adam Ableman *Governed Semantic Compilation: Lawful Continuation, Refusal Semantics, and Epistemic Promotion in Large Language Models.* Zenodo, 2026. doi:10.5281/zenodo.18453681

Adam Ableman *MCIR: A Canonical Intermediate Representation for Governed Transformation.* Zenodo, 2026. doi:10.5281/zenodo.21095303

Adam Ableman *Semantic Coordinate Identity Tokenization (SCIT).* Zenodo, 2026. doi:10.5281/zenodo.20532070

Corpus source and companion formats: https://github.com/AblemanMosaic/ableman-corpus
License: CC-BY-ND-4.0

DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.23847623